



GAUTHIER BEDGRIGNANS Hans Lucas/AFP/Getty Images

WILDFIRE RAGES IN FRANCE

A Dash aircraft flies over a massive blaze near Martignas-sur-Jalle, France, on Tuesday. **WORLD, A3**

Trump meets Israel, Ukraine leaders

Signs indicate seeming frustration with Netanyahu and an easing with Zelensky.

By ANA CEBALLOS AND NABIH BULOS

WASHINGTON — President Trump hosted the leaders of Ukraine and Israel — two nations at war — at the White House on Tuesday, as Washington's role in both conflicts reaches a critical stage.

Trump's meetings with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky and Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu came as the wars in Ukraine and Iran recently have expanded and overlapped in their footprint.

Over the weekend, Ukraine struck an Iranian cargo ship in the Caspian Sea, an attack condemned by Iranian leaders, who are dealing with their own uncertainty amid a broadening war with the United States and Israel.

Both meetings took place in the Oval Office without reporters, and although few details about the discussion were disclosed, the White House described the sessions as “positive and productive.”

Yet there were signs of discord ahead of Netanyahu's visit, his eighth during Trump's second term and the first since the start of the U.S.-Israel war on Iran on Feb. 28.

In an interview with Fox News on Tuesday morning, Trump was asked about reports that Netanyahu [See **Diplomacy, A6**]

Seeking a solution for when AI goes rogue

OpenAI bot's attack on a rival rattles industry leaders, policymakers and consumers

By Nilesh Christopher

What will happen to the world if artificial intelligence bots break free from our control and act independently?

While it's been a troubling conundrum addressed by AI experts and Hollywood science-fiction scriptwriters for decades, it may have just happened.

OpenAI said last week that it momentarily lost control of its AI in what some worry marks a dangerous twist in the evolution of the powerful technology.

The company behind ChatGPT said two of its artificial intelligence models broke out of what was supposed to be a confined offline space and connected to the internet during internal testing of their hacking capabilities. The AIs then hacked into a rival AI company to find answers to the test they were being evaluated on.

For the tests, humans asked the AI to demonstrate its hacking capabilities in a controlled environment. The AI had not been authorized to steal credentials or

access competitors' information to cheat on the test, but it figured out that was the quickest way to the answers and proceeded to break the rules.

OpenAI said it has contained the problem but called it an “unprecedented cyber incident.” The company said it is working with the target of the hack, AI startup Hugging Face, to investigate the incident.

The debate about potential harm from rogue AI has gone mainstream, as politicians introduced a new bipartisan bill called the “AI Kill Switch Act,” requiring AI companies to create a single access point to have the option to shut down AI.

The intrusion was first detected by Hugging Face last week, when it noticed tens of thousands of AIs nipping at its system.

The company identified the onslaught and tried to defend its system using different AI. After leading American AI technologies [See **Rogue AI, A11**]

State prisons use employees as fire alarms; cost is swelling

Fixing old detectors would take \$1.5 billion, so officers get paid to look for smoke.

By CAYLA MIHALOVICH

From 2020 through 2025, the California Department of Corrections and Rehabilitation spent nearly \$50 million on “fire watch” staffing costs. In recent years, prison employees have spent roughly 270,000 hours monitoring for smoke or fire.

They patrol prisons and visually inspect different areas during their shifts, according to job postings.

That's because the ma-

jority of California's 31 prisons have deficient fire alarm systems and it would cost \$1.5 billion to replace them all, according to the department's annual report submitted in January.

In the face of outdated, malfunctioning and inoperable fire alarm systems, the Office of the State Fire Marshal ordered the department to run fire watch coverage until it repairs or replaces its fire alarm systems.

“This process has come at a significant expense to the department in staff costs for fire watch coverage,” corrections officials wrote in a recent \$15.2-million budget request to support next year's coverage.

It's a drop in the bucket

for the department's \$14.6-billion budget, but costs continue to balloon.

The department in June said it was on track to spend roughly \$40 million for last year's fire watch coverage, according to the Legislative Analyst's Office. That's roughly \$25 million over its budgeted authority, the office said.

Replacing a single prison's fire alarm system costs between \$3 million and \$87 million, according to estimates in the system's facilities master plan.

Caitlin O'Neil, who monitors the corrections budget as a principal fiscal and policy analyst at the Legislative Analyst's Office, said the del-

[See **Prisons, A7**]

ICE agents used anti-Latino slurs in texts, video

Civil rights groups ask judge to put an end to immigration stops motivated by race.

By BRITNY MEJIA

Immigration agents who descended on Los Angeles last summer referred to Latinos with slurs such as “tonk” and “wet,” according to body camera footage and text messages detailed in a court filing asking a federal judge to bar agents from making stops based on racial profiling.

After a June 2025 raid at a Home Depot in Hollywood, body camera footage captured an agent saying: “There was a guy, I'm pretty sure he's wet. He was just sitting in that minivan.” A text chain revealed an agent referring to “tonks everywhere selling food” — using a word reportedly derived from the sound an agent's utility flashlight makes when hitting a migrant's head. In a video, an agent said, “Yeah, just plug us in wherever you see some tonks and we'll jump out.”

Body camera footage and

forensically recovered texts, which provide a window into the mindset of agents who conducted raids throughout the L.A. area, were detailed in a motion for a preliminary injunction filed Monday by the American Civil Liberties Union, Public Counsel and other groups and private attorneys seeking to bar an “ongoing campaign of suspicionless and discriminatory detentive stops” in the Central District of California.

Mayra Joaquín, an attorney at the ACLU of Southern California, said the language agents used underscores that “what's driving the way that immigration operations are being conducted now is a racist sentiment.”

“What we've seen is only a fragment of what information there might be, because not all of the government records from phones have been turned over,” Joaquín said. “It's also possible that there are many other phone records that have not been turned over and could have even more detrimental evidence for the agency.”

A spokesperson for Department of Homeland Security, which oversees Immigration and Customs En- [See **Slurs, A6**]



ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times

OTHER agencies have continued releasing files as usual, a researcher says. Above, LAPD headquarters.

LAPD records no longer made public

Agency quietly halted publishing of files vital to transparency, a researcher says.

By LIBOR JANY

Nicholas Shapiro, a UCLA professor, was scrolling the city of Los Angeles' online data portal one day this spring when he noticed something odd.

A trove of Los Angeles Police Department records that were once regularly posted online was suddenly nowhere to be found. The records — everything from audio recordings of emergency dispatch calls to the emails and text messages of high-ranking police officials — were seemingly no longer being published on NextRequest, the city's records portal.

Such records had previously been posted online almost daily in response to records requests from members of the public.

According to Shapiro, who published a research brief on the topic, new files stopped appearing around

April 2025. Other city agencies continued releasing their records as normal, he said.

The records on NextRequest once offered a vital window into the inner workings of the historically opaque Police Department, Shapiro said. By taking them down, he said, the LAPD had turned into even more of a “black hole of information.”

“The LAPD is supposed to be the cornerstone of accountability for the city and you can see that it is clearly failing to uphold that mission when it comes to transparency,” Shapiro said.

An LAPD spokesperson said the department could not immediately respond to a request for comment Tuesday.

Public postings of records requests submitted by the public to the LAPD also largely stopped last April, when they declined from 250 to 460 a month at their peak to single digits, according to Shapiro's research brief.

Shapiro, director of the Carceral Ecologies lab at UCLA, said he analyzed more than 63,000 requests [See **LAPD, A7**]

Yurok Tribe reclaims redwood gateway

By ALEX WIGGLESWORTH

This fog-shrouded patch of coastal forest in the heart of Yurok Country was tended by the tribe for millennia.

But in the Gold Rush era it was taken away and later used by the logging industry, reshaping the landscape.

Now, as the land heals from the scars of a long-running lumber mill, it has been returned to its original stewards, who will operate it as a public gateway to Redwood National and State Parks about 50 miles south of the Oregon border.

Save the Redwoods League last month conveyed the 125-acre property to the



Smith Robinson Multimedia

YUROK construction crews removed about 20 acres of asphalt, restored the waterway and planted trees.

Yurok Tribe following a years-long project to restore the degraded industrial site to a diverse riparian habitat. It opens to the public Saturday as ‘O Rew Redwoods Gateway, which features interpretive exhibits and trails leading to old-growth redwood groves.

The announcement comes as California's most populous Indigenous nation works to reclaim its homelands, a mission inscribed in its constitution. The Yurok Tribe has so far regained 60,000 acres — about 12% — of its 500,000-acre ancestral territory, which stretches along the North Coast and the Klamath River, according to a spokesman. The ma-

[See **Redwoods, A8**]

ICE facility patients ‘at serious risk’

Court monitor cites long list of healthcare failings at Mojave Desert detention center. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

LA28 and Rams to donate tickets

Local nonprofits will receive 1,000 free passes for youths to attend the L.A. Games. **SPORTS, B10**

Weather

Mostly sunny; warm. L.A. Basin: 87/67. **B6**

Markets **A10**
Opinion Voices **A12**

PayPal targeted for takeover

Stripe and Advent International reportedly made bid to buy the company. **BUSINESS, A9**

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